A brief entry in *Lloyd's Register of British and Foreign Shipping* notes that, in 1911, the *Gallia* was sold to J. Mackintosh and Company.[52] In May 1911, it was tugged away to Bombay and was therefore presumably sold before the liquidation of SSNCo.[53]

Again, from the same source, we learn that the *Lawoe* was sold to one P. Easwaramurthia Pillai in 1911.[54] In November 1911, it sailed from Bombay and reached Aden on 11 November en route to Jeddah.

No further details can be traced of these transactions.

Ashe is Assassinated

But the drama was far from over.

Weeks before the formal liquidation of SSNCo was initiated, Robert William D'Escourt Ashe, notorious for his role in the 'riots' in Tuticorin and in intimidating SSNCo, was shot dead—the only political assassination in the Tamil country during the freedom struggle.[55]

After the high drama of March 1908, Ashe had been unceremoniously transferred to Godavari in mid-April—he had spent only two months in Tuticorin. Wynch's backing had not helped in averting this slight. In December, he was posted in nearby Sattur. Though he officiated for a month in the absence of its collector in April 1910, it was only in August that he was appointed as acting collector of Tirunelveli. Nearly a year later, on 17 June 1911, he was shot at point blank range when he was in his first-class coach on a train at Maniyachi Junction with his wife, waiting to travel to Madurai en route to the hill resort of Kodaikanal. The assassin R. Vanchi Iyer, a member of a secret society, killed himself immediately. Following this, a massive manhunt was launched. Fourteen were arraigned in the conspiracy case: Special Bench Case No. 1 of 1911, *The King-Emperor vs Nilakanta alias Brahmachari and 13 others*. A special tribunal of the Madras High Court, consisting of Chief Justice Charles Arnold White, C. Sankaran Nair and W.B. Ayling heard the case. In the investigation leading up to the trial all suspects were seen to have connections with the Swadeshi movement and, more particularly, SSNCo. In the cross-examination of